



الخدمت فاؤنڈیشن پاکستان
ALKHIDMAT FOUNDATION PAKISTAN

Alkhidmat Foundation Pakistan

Summer Internship Program 2026

Week 1 Virtual Internship Report

Department: Volunteer Management

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This report is submitted in fulfilment of the Week 1 deliverable of the Alkhidmat Summer Internship Program 2026, comprising the orientation report and the Assignment 1 research project.

1 Orientation report (Week 1)

1.1 Overview of the orientation session

The Week 1 orientation marked the beginning of the Alkhidmat Summer Internship Program 2026, a six-week national initiative run by Alkhidmat Foundation Pakistan. The session was conducted in hybrid mode, with participants based outside Lahore, including me attending virtually. The orientation introduced the program's structure, expectations, and grading system, and situated the internship within Alkhidmat's broader mission as a welfare organisation active in disaster relief, healthcare, education, orphan care, and community development.

The program registered over 30,000 applicants nationwide for the current cycle, with roughly 6,000 applicants from Lahore alone, reflecting the scale of youth interest in the initiative. Alkhidmat's own volunteer network, cited during the session, exceeds 90,000 registered volunteers across Pakistan.

1.2 Key topics and segments covered

The orientation segment for Week 1 covered the following areas:

- An outline of the six-week program journey, moving from orientation and exposure in Week 1 through leadership development, emergency preparedness training, digital skills, community action projects, and volunteer mobilisation with graduation in Week 6.
- Physical and virtual exposure visits to Alkhidmat's local service projects, including schools, child protection centres, and health facilities, intended to give interns direct exposure to field operations.
- The grading and attendance policy: a 60-mark structure across six weeks (10 marks each), a 35-mark threshold for a completion certificate, and a weekly breakdown covering participation, proof of attendance, assignment quality, and report formatting. Missing two consecutive weekly submissions results in being dropped from the program.
- Youth-focused context for the program: unemployment and mental health strain linked to career-mismatch stress, reported as affecting a majority of graduates entering a constrained job market. Alkhidmat's Volunteer Department was presented as running a free Psychology Club and counselling services in response.
- National statistics used to motivate the program's relevance, including the number of out-of-school children in Pakistan (in the tens of millions) and several million orphans nationwide.
- Flagship initiatives such as the Bano Qabil free IT training program and a GenZ entrepreneurship initiative aimed at supporting new youth-led startups, alongside a brief overview of Alkhidmat's international relief operations.

1.3 Learnings and reflections

The orientation clarified that this internship is structured less as a conventional office placement and more as a volunteer-mobilisation and civic-exposure program, with weekly deliverables tied directly to attendance and reporting discipline rather than to a fixed office task list. The attendance policy in

particular stood out: since participation is tracked solely through timely weekly report submission rather than any other monitoring mechanism, consistency in reporting was framed as the single most important factor in completing the program successfully.

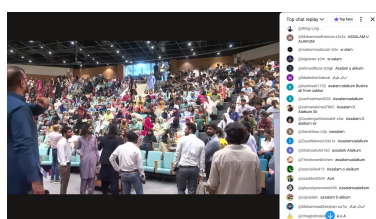
The scale figures shared during the session, tens of thousands of applicants and a volunteer base of similar size, gave a clearer sense of Alkhidmat's operating capacity relative to its stated mission. It was also useful to see how the organisation connects its Volunteer Management department (the department this internship is assigned to) with grassroots programs such as Bano Qabil and the Psychology Club, rather than treating volunteer coordination as a purely administrative function separate from service delivery.

1.4 Screenshots and photographs

The following images are included as proof of participation in the Week 1 virtual orientation session, per the program's attendance policy.



Figure 1: Week 1 orientation session.



(a) Screenshot 1



(b) Screenshot 2



(c) Screenshot 3

Figure 2: Proof of participation, Week 1 virtual orientation session.

2 Research project (Assignment 1)

The Role of Islamic Teachings and Volunteerism in Addressing Pakistan's Social Challenges: The Contribution of Alkhidmat Foundation Pakistan

2.1 Introduction

Pakistan faces a cluster of interlocking social challenges: disaster vulnerability, gaps in access to health-care and education, unmet orphan and widow support needs, and constrained formal-sector employment for young people. Government capacity to address these gaps at scale is limited, particularly during large-scale disasters, which has historically created space for faith-based and community-driven welfare organisations to take on a substantial share of frontline service delivery. Alkhidmat Foundation Pakistan, registered as a non-governmental, non-profit organisation in 1990 and operating as the welfare wing of Jamaat-e-Islami Pakistan, is one of the most visible examples of this model.¹ This report examines how Islamic principles of volunteerism (khidmat) and charitable obligation inform Alkhidmat's operating model, and reviews its documented contribution across disaster relief, health, education, and economic empowerment.

2.2 Islamic teachings as an organisational foundation

Alkhidmat's public messaging frames its work explicitly around Islamic concepts of service to humanity, describing volunteering with the organisation as guided by Islamic principles and open to all regardless of religion, caste, or ethnic background.^{2 3} This framing draws on the broader Islamic tradition of zakat (obligatory almsgiving), sadaqah (voluntary charity), and mawakhat (brotherhood-based mutual support). Each appears directly in Alkhidmat's program design: the organisation operates dedicated zakat and sadaqah channels, and its Mawakhat program applies interest-free lending to small-business support, including targeted efforts to include transgender individuals in economic opportunity.⁴

2.3 Scale and documented impact

Independently reported figures give a sense of the organisation's current scale. Alkhidmat's provincial leadership reported that the foundation delivered welfare services worth Rs26.41 billion across Pakistan in 2025, reaching more than 24.6 million people, spanning disaster relief, education, healthcare, orphan sponsorship, clean water provision, microfinance, and the Bano Qabil IT training program.⁵ Separately, the organisation reported serving over 2.5 million people through free medical care, health camps, and essential medication provision in 2025.⁶

Disaster response constitutes a significant share of this activity. During the 2025 monsoon floods, Alkhidmat reported conducting nearly 1,900 rescue and relief missions, rescuing more than 33,000

¹ Alkhidmat Foundation Pakistan. *Wikipedia*. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alkhidmat_Foundation_Pakistan

² Alkhidmat Foundation Pakistan, official site. <https://alkhidmat.org/>

³ Alkhidmat Foundation Islamabad. <https://alkhidmat.isb.org/>

⁴ Alkhidmat Foundation Pakistan. *Wikipedia*, Mawakhat program description.

⁵ "Alkhidmat Foundation delivers Rs26.41bn welfare services in 2025." *The News International*, 2026. <https://www.thenews.pk/print/1398820-alkhidmat-foundation-delivers-rs26-41bn-welfare-services-in-2025>

⁶ Alkhidmat: Pakistan's leading NGO in Humanitarian Services. <https://www.alkhidmat.com/>

people with the support of over 40,000 volunteers, and separately disclosed spending of Rs1.10 billion on flood relief and rehabilitation, including distribution of over 424,000 cooked food boxes, monthly rations for nearly 44,700 families, and the establishment of fifteen tent villages housing over 16,000 people.⁷ In the health sector, the same flood response deployed eight mobile health units, 767 medical camps, and 60 ambulances, reaching close to 200,000 patients and injured persons, alongside WASH interventions distributing hundreds of thousands of water bottles and thousands of hygiene and dignity kits.⁸

In Khyber Pakhtunkhwa specifically, the Bano Qabil program had established 50 centres offering 28 free IT and digital skills courses, graduating more than 10,000 students in 2025 into local or online employment.⁹ At a national level, Bano Qabil has recorded over 1.5 million online registrations, and Alkhidmat has separately promoted a GenZ entrepreneurship initiative aimed at supporting the creation of 100,000 new youth-led startups.

Alkhidmat's international humanitarian activity has also expanded its footprint beyond Pakistan. Under its Gaza relief operation, the organisation reported delivering 6,014 tonnes of relief goods worth Rs9.09 billion in 2025 and allocating a further Rs15 billion toward reconstruction work.¹⁰ A peer-reviewed case study of the organisation notes more than 250 recorded MOUs and institutional collaborations within its Volunteer Management program alone, including partnerships with the World Health Organization, the National Disaster Management Authority, and several Pakistani medical and academic institutions.¹¹

Table 1 summarises the headline 2025 figures cited above by sector.

Table 1: Alkhidmat Foundation Pakistan: documented 2025 activity by sector

Sector	Reported figure	Source
Overall welfare services	Rs26.41 billion delivered; 24.6 million+ people reached	Provincial press briefing, 2025
Healthcare	2.5 million+ people served with free medical care	Alkhidmat.com
Flood relief (2025)	Rs1.10 billion spent; 424,051 cooked food boxes; 44,695 families on monthly rations	Alkhidmat.org press release
Flood rescue operations	1,900 missions; 33,000+ people rescued; 40,000+ volunteers mobilised	Alkhidmat.org
Bano Qabil (KP only)	50 centres; 28 courses; 10,000+ graduates in 2025	The News International
Gaza relief	6,014 tonnes delivered, worth Rs9.09 billion; Rs15 billion allocated for reconstruction	The News International

⁷“Alkhidmat Foundation Spends Rs1.10 Billion on Flood Relief and Rehabilitation Across Pakistan.” Alkhidmat Foundation Pakistan, 23 September 2025. <https://alkhidmat.org/about-us/latest/blog/alkhidmat-foundation-spends-rs110-billion-on-flood-relief-and-rehabilitation-across-pakistan>

⁸Ibid.

⁹“Alkhidmat Foundation delivers Rs26.41bn welfare services in 2025.” *The News International*.

¹⁰“Alkhidmat Foundation delivers Rs26.41bn welfare services in 2025.” *The News International*.

¹¹Journal of the British Islamic Medical Association. “Alkhidmat Foundation Pakistan: A Study of Islamic Humanitarianism, Multi-Sectoral Service Delivery, and Global Impact.” <https://jbima.com/article/alkhidmat-foundation-pakistan-a-study-of-islamic-humanitarianism-multi-sectoral-service-delivery-and-global-impact/>

Figure 3 charts the flood-relief distribution figures from Table 1 to illustrate the relative scale of the different relief components.

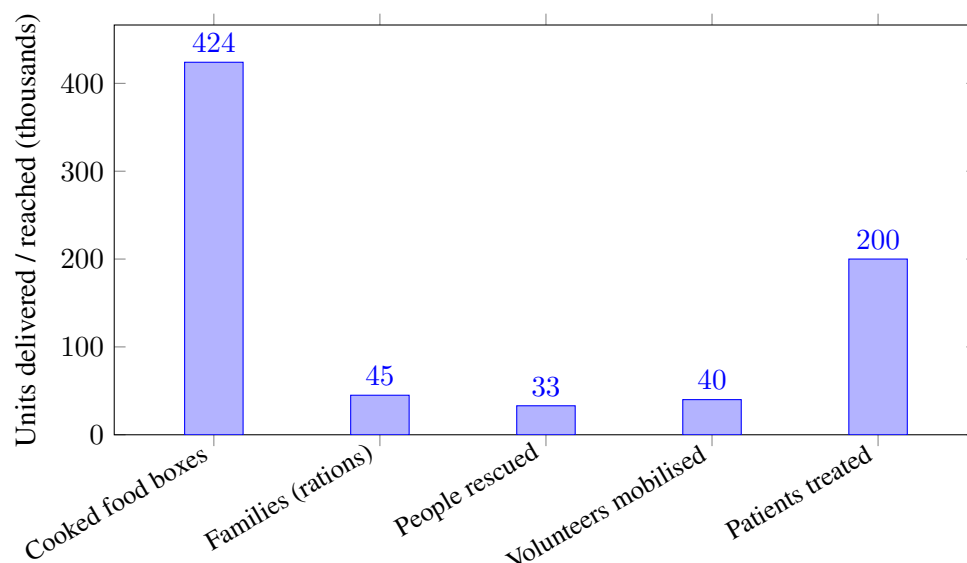


Figure 3: Scale of Alkhidmat's 2025 flood-relief response (figures in thousands, rounded). Source: Alkhidmat Foundation Pakistan press release, 23 September 2025, and Alkhidmat Disaster Management Services page.

2.4 Volunteerism as the operational core

What distinguishes Alkhidmat's model from a conventional service-delivery NGO is the centrality of unpaid, faith-motivated volunteer labour to its operations. The organisation's own volunteer base is reported in the tens of thousands, and disaster response operations in 2025 mobilised over 40,000 volunteers for flood relief alone. The Summer Internship Program itself, of which this report is a part, is explicitly designed as a volunteer-development pipeline: interns are unpaid, evaluated primarily on participation and reporting discipline rather than technical output, and directed toward downstream volunteer recruitment as part of their Week 6 deliverable. That volunteer base is what allows the organisation to scale services, such as the 2025 flood response above, that would otherwise require paid staffing well beyond its financial reach.

2.5 Discussion

Taken together, the available figures point to an organisation whose scale of service delivery is large relative to Pakistan's NGO sector, and whose operating logic is explicitly grounded in Islamic charitable obligation rather than a secular development framework. This has practical implications: zakat and sadaqah provide a recurring, religiously motivated funding base that does not depend solely on institutional donors, and the volunteer model allows rapid mobilisation during disasters, as seen in the 2025 flood response. At the same time, the figures cited in this report are drawn from Alkhidmat's own disclosures and affiliated media coverage rather than from independent third-party audits, and should be read with that limitation in mind. A more rigorous assessment of long-term outcomes (employment retention among Bano Qabil graduates, or repayment and business-survival rates under Mawakhat, for example)

would require primary data collection that falls outside the scope of this report, a limitation also noted in the peer-reviewed literature on the organisation.¹²

2.6 Conclusion

Alkhidmat Foundation Pakistan illustrates how Islamic teachings on charity and mutual obligation can be translated into a functioning, large-scale welfare infrastructure operating alongside, and in some respects ahead of, formal state capacity in disaster response. Its documented 2025 activity, spanning disaster relief, healthcare, education, and microfinance, and reaching tens of millions of people, demonstrates the practical reach that a volunteer-driven, faith-motivated model can achieve in a country facing significant and recurring social challenges. The Summer Internship Program's own design, built around volunteer mobilisation rather than paid task completion, reflects this same logic at a smaller scale.

References

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¹²Journal of the British Islamic Medical Association, op. cit.